

EQUINOX FRONTIER MARKETS WEEKLY

INSTITUTIONAL MARKET INTELLIGENCE

Nigeria

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- Chip-led risk-off gripped global markets as the Philadelphia semis index posted its steepest weekly loss in over a year, dragging KOSPI -6.46% and the S&P 500 -1.55%, while US-Iran escalation drove Brent to \$87.94/bbl.
- The NGX ASI eased 0.20% WoW to 243,462.13, consolidating just below its 52-week high with YTD returns intact at +56.45%, as Ghana (+70.29% YTD) and Egypt (+1.18% WoW) led frontier Africa.
- Banking dominated the rotation with a +9.30% WoW index surge powered by First HoldCo's +38.66% rally to ₦95.95 on completed ₦500bn recapitalisation, while BUA Cement's -18.99% collapse dragged Industrials -6.26%.
- June CPI eased to 15.91% YoY — the first decline after three monthly increases — while the naira held at ₦1,378.08/\$ and reserves reached a 17-year-high \$51.86bn, anchoring expectations of an MPC hold.
- The 21–22 July MPC decision, DMO's ₦1.2tn bond auction and the 24–31 July earnings cluster (DANGCEM, MTN, FUGAZ banks) are likely to determine whether banking outperformance broadens beyond recapitalisation beneficiaries, with fixed-income yields near 18.3% the key rotation risk.

Market Outlook — Coming Week

- Policy sets the tone early: consensus expects the CBN MPC (21–22 Jul) to hold the MPR at 26.50% after June CPI's dip to 15.91%; a hold with neutral-to-dovish language extends the equity bid, while any tightening bias triggers profit-taking in rate-sensitive financials.
- Fixed-income competition is the week's swing factor — the DMO's ₦1.2tn auction (settlement 22 Jul) across 10/15/20-yr re-openings will test whether 18%+ stop rates pull institutional liquidity from equities; watch the bid-to-cover against H1's 1.9x average.
- Earnings take over from mid-week: Dangote Cement's Q2 (24 Jul) is the single print most capable of unfreezing the Industrial Goods complex after BUA Cement's -19% rout, with the street TP of ₦1,359.79 implying ~30% headroom over the frozen ₦1,047 close.
- The banking overweight faces its verdict at month-end — MTN's board (29 Jul) then Zenith, Access, First HoldCo and Nigerian Breweries (30 Jul); interim dividend declarations and cost-of-risk trends decide whether the +9.30% sector surge compounds or unwinds, with First HoldCo at 41.2x carrying the highest expectations bar.
- Technically, the ASI remains capped by the 241,000–245,000 resistance band, 0.14% below its 52-week high; a breakout requires the heavyweight complex (Airtel, DANGCEM, MTN, BUA Foods — all flat WoW) to re-engage, while breadth (A/D 1.26x, down from 2.13x) argues for consolidation absent an earnings catalyst.

- Positioning stance: hold the Banking OW into results but favour undervalued names (Zenith 8.6x, Access 8.9x, Fidelity) over fully re-rated momentum; keep Industrials UW pending the DANGCEM print; treat any pre-MPC dip toward 240,000 as accumulation territory rather than trend reversal.

SECTION 1 | GLOBAL MARKETS SNAPSHOT

Index / Market	This Week Close	WoW %	MoM %	YTD %	52-Wk High	52-Wk Low
S&P 500 (USA)	7,457.69	-1.55%	+0.51%	+8.94%	7,609.78	6,238.01
STOXX 600 (Europe)	641.53	+0.07%	+0.35%	+8.22%	652.77	535.79
Nikkei 225 (Japan)	64,141.12	-6.44%	-8.24%	+27.42%	72,366.34	39,774.92
Shanghai Comp. (China)	3,764.15	-5.81%	-8.37%	-5.16%	4,242.57	3,503.78
KOSPI (South Korea)	6,820.60	-6.46%	-11.77%	+61.85%	9,114.55	3,119.41

Global Markets Commentary

- ▼ Chip-led risk-off dominated the week: the Philadelphia semis index posted its steepest weekly loss in over a year (-18% in July, still +65% YTD), dragging KOSPI -6.46% WoW, Nikkei -6.44% and the S&P 500 -1.55%.
- ▲ US-Iran escalation kept energy elevated: Washington's naval blockade of Iranian ports shut the Strait of Hormuz, with a Red Sea closure threatened; Brent ended +4.40% Friday at \$87.94/bbl, stoking inflation concerns.
- ▲ Cooler US CPI and PPI prints offset the geopolitical premium, with markets pricing out a July Fed hike; the 10-yr Treasury yield eased to 4.55% and the dollar index held near one-month lows at 100.73.
- ▼ Asia underperformed broadly: Shanghai fell 5.81% WoW (-8.37% MoM, -5.16% YTD), while Europe proved defensive — STOXX 600 flat at +0.07% WoW and +8.22% YTD, closing near its 652.77 52-wk high.

SECTION 2 | FRONTIER AFRICA MARKETS SCOREBOARD

Market / Index	Index Level	WoW %	MoM %	YTD %	Mkt Cap
Nigeria — NGX ASI	243,462.13	-0.14%	+1.10%	+56.45%	₦157.06 trillion
South Africa — JSE All Share	109,569.92	-0.71%	-5.56%	-5.41%	R21.25 trillion
Kenya — NSE All Share	231.57	+1.10%	+5.30%	+24.11%	Ksh3.73 trillion
Egypt — EGX 30	52,928.06	+1.18%	+1.19%	+26.53%	EGP3.69 trillion
Ghana — GSE Composite	14,938.00	+0.90%	+2.25%	+70.29%	GHS288.05 billion

African FX Snapshot

Currency Pair	Rate (Fri Close)	WoW Chg	WoW %	YTD %	As-of Date
USD/NGN (Nigeria Official)	1,378.08	-0.26	-0.02%	-4.73%	2026-07-17
USD/ZAR (South Africa)	16.48	0.12	+0.74%	-0.17%	2026-07-17
USD/KES (Kenya)	128.30	0.04	+0.03%	+0.23%	2026-07-17
USD/EGP (Egypt)	50.42	0.84	+1.69%	+5.72%	2026-07-17
USD/GHS (Ghana)	11.53	0.11	+0.96%	+5.78%	2026-07-17
USD/NGN Parallel (Bureau)	1,425.00	15.00	+1.06%	-2.06%	2026-07-17

Frontier Africa Commentary

- ▲ Egypt led the region, EGX 30 +1.18% WoW (+26.53% YTD), with Kenya +1.10% and Ghana +0.90% (+70.29% YTD, the continent's best) extending East/West African momentum on sustained local liquidity.
- ▼ South Africa was the week's laggard, JSE All Share -0.71% WoW (-5.41% YTD), as Strait of Hormuz disruption pressured precious metals — the JSE precious metals and mining index fell 6.0%, dragging Resources -4.8%.
- ▼ Nigeria eased, ASI -0.14% WoW after its run to +56.45% YTD; the official naira held firm at ₦1,378.08/\$ (-0.02% WoW) while the parallel rate widened 1.06% to ₦1,425, a ₦47 spread.
- ▲ Gulf capital is emerging as the region's structural macro theme: GCC investors committed \$53bn across 73 African FDI projects in 2023, targeting the continent's ~\$80bn annual infrastructure financing gap as Chinese policy-bank lending fell to \$2.1bn in 2024.

SECTION 3 | NIGERIA — MARKET PULSE

NGX ASI Level 243,462.13	Weekly Change -0.14%	YTD Return +56.45%	Market Cap (₦tn) ₦157.06 tn
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Weekly Volume (mn) 2,818.60 m	Turnover (₦ bn) ₦182.49 bn	Advances 44	Declines 35
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Unchanged 67	A/D Ratio 1.26x	Number of Deals 226,729	52-Wk ASI Range 126,689.54 – 243,798.76
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Market Snapshot Commentary

- The ASI eased 0.14% WoW to 243,462.13, a 336.63-point pullback that consolidates the prior week's outsized +6.35% advance rather than reversing it; YTD return held at +56.45%. Market capitalisation increased despite the lower index reading, rising ₦612bn to ₦157.06tn — a divergence suggesting changes in free float, additional listings, or share adjustments that should be confirmed against NGX's official capitalisation file rather than attributed to a single cause.
- Activity cooled markedly from the prior week's elevated base. Volume fell 22.7% WoW to 2.82bn shares, and value traded declined to ₦182.49bn. Deal count dropped 10.0% to 226,729. Breadth narrowed but stayed positive: 44 advancers against 35 decliners (A/D ratio 1.26x, down from 2.13x), with 67 counters unchanged — consistent with profit-taking concentrated in recent outperformers rather than broad distribution.
- The index sits 0.14% below its 52-week high of 243,798.76 — set the prior week — keeping the 241,000–245,000 resistance band in play.

SECTION 4 | NIGERIA — SECTORAL SCOREBOARD

Index / Sector	This Week Close	Prior Week Close	WoW %	MoM %	YTD %	QtD %	Signal
NGX All-Share Index (ASI)	243,462.13	243,798.76	-0.14%	6.12%	56.45 %	6.12%	▼ Consolidating below 245k
NGX Main Board Index	11,159.59	11,334.16	-1.54%	3.33%	48.21 %	3.33%	▼ Laggard (~1.54% WoW)
NGX 30 Index	8,898.73	8,868.81	0.34%	6.88%	56.87 %	6.88%	▲ Large caps resilient
NGX Banking Index	2,348.99	2,149.14	9.30%	13.47%	54.96 %	13.47 %	▲ Week's leader (+9.30%)
NGX Consumer Goods Index	4,684.75	4,691.90	-0.15%	1.97%	17.84 %	1.97%	▼ Marginally lower
NGX Oil & Gas Index	5,249.44	5,255.03	-0.11%	3.35%	96.59 %	3.35%	▼ Flat despite Brent surge
NGX Industrial Goods Index	10,042.21	10,713.01	-6.26%	-1.18%	76.91 %	-1.18%	▼ BUA Cement ~19% drag
NGX Insurance Index	1,135.86	1,132.98	0.25%	3.44%	-4.50%	3.44%	▲ Slightly firmer
NGX Pension Index	12,218.28	11,799.21	3.55%	9.89%	71.65 %	9.89%	▲ Steady accumulation
NGX Sovereign Bond Index	668.10	670.30	-0.33%	-0.97%	-2.06%	-0.97%	▼ Yield pressure persists

Market Snapshot Commentary

- The Banking Index led decisively, +9.30% WoW (+13.47% MoM), powered by First HoldCo's rally to a record ₦95.95 — the stock is +55.66% MTD on completed CBN ₦500bn recapitalisation, institutional block demand (₦19.43bn crossed Tuesday) and improving earnings, with UBA (+7.93% Thursday) and Zenith adding support.
- Industrial Goods was the clear laggard, -6.26% WoW, dragged by BUA Cement's ~19% weekly collapse across successive limit-down sessions (₦340.20 to ₦275.60) alongside CAP -9.61%, as profit-taking hit low-free-float heavyweights. Pension (+3.55%) tracked banking strength; Oil & Gas stayed flat (-0.11%) despite Brent's surge to \$87.94, while the Sovereign Bond Index slipped 0.33% on persistent yield pressure.
- Rotation signal: trading activity suggests institutional flows may be concentrating in recapitalisation-driven Tier-1 banks while easing out of fully-valued industrials — watch whether banking outperformance broadens beyond recapitalisation beneficiaries into H1 earnings season.

SECTION 5 | NIGERIA — TOP MOVERS
▲ Top 10 Gainers

#	Ticker	Company	Close (₦)	WoW %	Weekly Vol	Value Traded (₦)
1	FIRSTHOLDCO		95.95	+38.66%	225,912,721	21,676,325,580
2	THOMASWY		3.09	+27.16%	14,746,422	45,566,444
3	FIDELITYBK		21.85	+15.00%	25,754,444	562,734,601
4	LEARNAFRCA		10.30	+14.44%	278,502	2,868,571
5	UBA		45.50	+10.98%	27,511,022	1,251,751,501
6	GREENWETF		838.99	+10.12%	2,554	2,142,780
7	NIDF		163.30	+9.97%	117,795	19,235,924
8	LIVINGTRUST		3.72	+9.73%	447,165	1,663,454
9	NREIT		113.00	+9.71%	124,219	14,036,747
10	STANBIC		166.90	+9.66%	383,145	63,946,901

▼ Top 10 Losers

#	Ticker	Company	Close (₦)	WoW %	Weekly Vol	Value Traded (₦)
1	BUACEMENT		275.60	-18.99%	17,411,684	4,798,660,110
2	REDSTAREX		20.00	-18.53%	309,675	6,193,500
3	INTENEGINS		4.66	-15.27%	359,641	1,675,927
4	CILEASING		5.55	-13.28%	633,204	3,514,282
5	PZ		80.95	-10.06%	1,320,411	106,887,270
6	EUNISELL		189.00	-10.00%	27,526	5,202,414
7	CAVERTON		5.00	-9.91%	3,533,303	17,666,515
8	CAP		142.45	-9.61%	78,699	11,210,673
9	JAPAUFGOLD		2.95	-8.95%	10,512,159	31,010,869
10	CADBURY		57.00	-8.95%	615,643	35,091,651

Most Active — Volume

#	Ticker	Company	Close (₦)	WoW %	Weekly Vol	Value Traded (₦)
1	FIRSTHOLDCO		95.95	+38.66%	225,912,721	21,676,325,580
2	GUINEAINS		0.87	0.00%	53,404,202	46,461,656
3	ZENITHBANK		114.00	+2.89%	41,520,455	4,733,331,870
4	ACCESSCORP		25.00	+0.20%	29,122,169	728,054,225
5	UBA		45.50	+10.98%	27,511,022	1,251,751,501

Most Active — Value

#	Ticker	Company	Close (₦)	WoW %	Weekly Vol	Value Traded (₦)
1	FIRSTHOLDCO		95.95	+38.66%	225,912,721	21,676,325,580
2	BUACEMENT		275.60	-18.99%	17,411,684	4,798,660,110
3	ZENITHBANK		114.00	+2.89%	41,520,455	4,733,331,870
4	UBA		45.50	+10.98%	27,511,022	1,251,751,501
5	GTCO		129.20	+2.54%	9,579,089	1,237,618,299

Market Movers Commentary

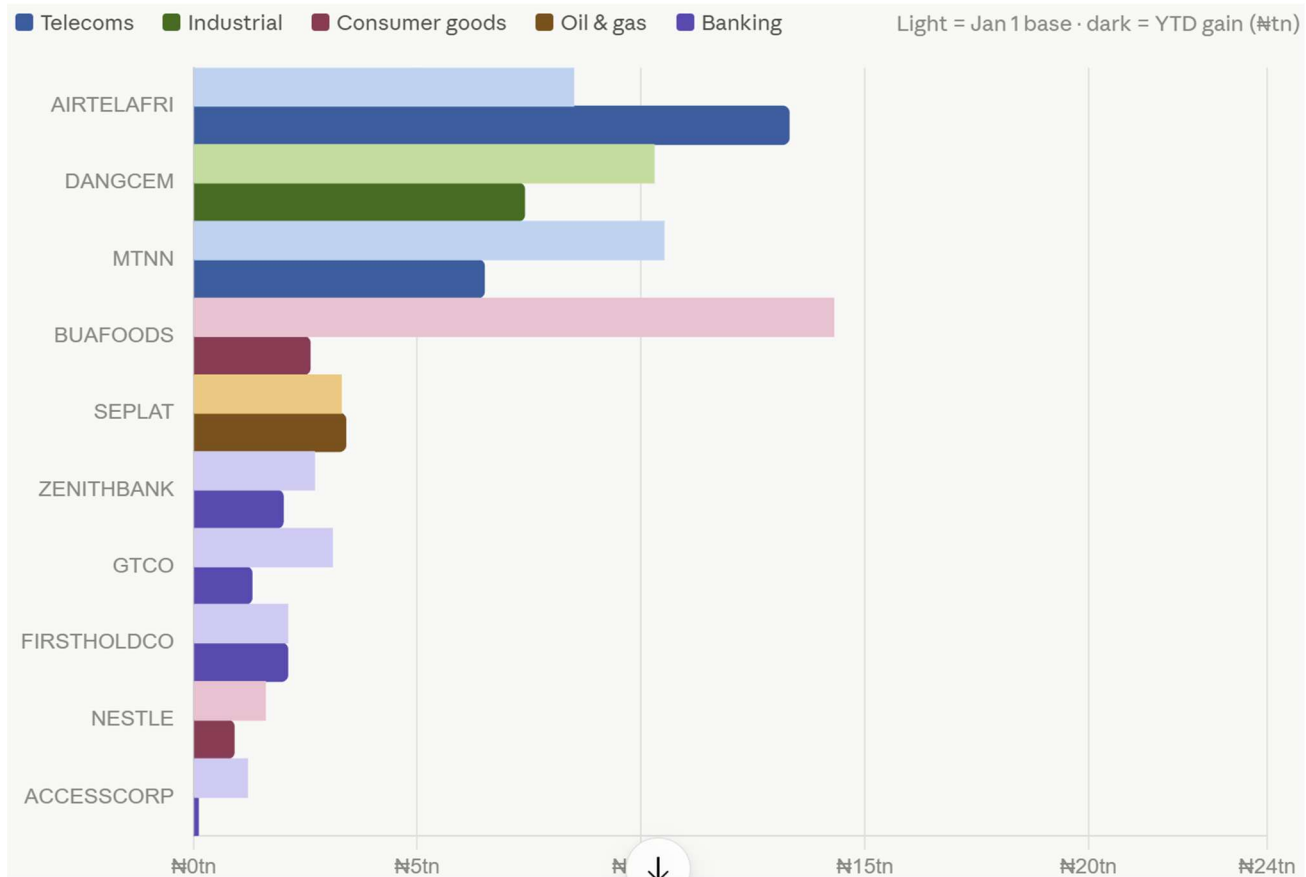
- First HoldCo's +38.66% WoW surge to ₦95.95 was the week's most significant price action — ₦21.68bn traded on 225.9m shares — driven by completed ₦500bn CBN recapitalisation, block-trade demand and record earnings expectations. BUA Cement's -18.99% collapse across successive limit-down sessions is consistent with institutional profit-taking in a low-free-float heavyweight at a stretched valuation. Fidelity (+15.00%) and UBA (+10.98%) confirm the recapitalisation trade broadening across Tier-1 and Tier-2 banks.

Large-Cap Watch List

Ticker	Close (₦)	Prev Close	WoW %	Weekly Vol	YTD %	P/E	Analyst Note
MTNN	827	824	+0.36 %	13,806,372	+62 %	13	+0.36% WoW; block crosses up to ₦849.9 signal institutional demand; undemanding at 13x vs telecom peer Airtel at 25x.
GTCO	129	127	+1.73 %	84,597,710	+40 %	18	+1.7% WoW as Banking index led the market (+9.30%); undemanding at 18.2x.
DANGCEM	1,047	1,047	0.00 %	5,541,211	+72 %	16	Flat at ₦1,047 (verified — genuine freeze, not stale data); +72% YTD; Q2 results due 24 July; street TP ₦1,359.79.
ACCESSCORP	25	25	+1.42 %	171,564,583	+9 %	9	+1.4% WoW; among top-3 traded by volume this week; deepest value of the majors at 8.9x.
BUAFOODS	939	939	0.00 %	680,145	+18 %	33	Flat at ₦939 since June on ~5% free float; ₦28 final dividend approved; 33x with no price discovery — value-trap risk.
AIRTELAFRI	5,801	5,801	0.00 %	54,872	+156 %	25	Paused after prior week's +21% limit-up run; now NGX's most valuable at ₦21.8tn; +156% YTD leader; 25x.
ZENITHBANK	114	111	+2.70 %	142,524,557	+77 %	9	+2.7% WoW; cheapest large bank at 8.6x; clear beneficiary of the banking rally.
FIRSTHOLDCO	96	87	+9.97 %	691,914,340	+97 %	41	NGX top gainer: +38.66% WoW (69.20→95.95); re-rated to 41.2x post-surge. (EODHD WoW% understates — stale prev close.)
NESTLE	3,125	3,125	0.00 %	164,724	+60 %	76	Unchanged; premium 75.7x vs Consumer Goods index -0.15% WoW.
SEPLAT	11,364	11,364	0.00 %	2,533,305	+103 %	53	Flat despite Brent +14% WoW; Oil & Gas index -0.11%; 53.4x.

Market Movers Commentary

- Large caps lagged the rotation beneath them: the NGX 30 rose just 0.34% WoW against Banking's +9.30% surge. First HoldCo (already the week's biggest mover — see above) dominated turnover at 691.9m shares; at 41.2x it now trades at a significant valuation premium to Zenith (8.6x, +2.70% WoW) and Access (8.9x), the cheapest majors.
- Airtel Africa paused at ₦5,801.40 after the prior week's 21% re-rating that made it the NGX's most valuable company at ₦21.8tn (+156% YTD, 25x).
- Dangote Cement and BUA Foods held genuinely flat at ₦1,047 and ₦939 — the latter's ~5% free float leaving 33x untested by price discovery.

NGX Large Cap: Market Cap, YTD Performance and Sector

Market Movers Commentary

The sector lens this week shows the large-cap complex consolidating after the prior week's surge, with the ASI easing ▼0.14% WoW while YTD held at ▲56.45%. This edition rebases market caps to verified NGX capitalisation data, correcting material understatements in the prior chart and reordering the leaderboard:

- Telecoms (blue) — Airtel Africa is now the NGX's most valuable company at ₦21.8tn, flat WoW at ₦5,801.40 after the prior week's ~21% re-rating; YTD holds at ▲156%, the segment leader. MTNN slips to third at ₦17.0tn, edging ▲0.36% WoW to ₦827 (▲62% YTD), with block crosses up to ₦849.9 signalling continued institutional demand at an undemanding 13x.
- Industrial (green) — Dangote Cement holds second at ₦17.7tn, genuinely flat at ₦1,047 (▲72% YTD); Q2 results due 24 July are the next catalyst, with the street's TP at ₦1,359.79.
- Consumer goods (pink) — BUA Foods, fourth at ₦16.9tn, remains frozen at ₦939 since June (▲18% YTD) on a ~5% free float — a heavyweight cap with no price discovery. Nestlé (▲60% YTD, 76x) stayed flat at ₦3,125.
- Oil & Gas (amber) — Seplat, ~₦6.7tn, closed unchanged at ₦11,364 (▲103% YTD, 53.4x) despite Brent's ▲14.70% WoW surge and ₦13.19bn traded Thursday.
- Banking (purple) — the week's only live segment. First HoldCo surged ▲38.66% WoW to ₦95.95, pushing its cap through ₦4tn and YTD to ▲97% at 41.2x — now the richest bank by multiple. Zenith rose ▲2.70% to ₦114 (▲77% YTD, 8.6x), GTCO reached ▲40% YTD at 18x, and Access lagged at ▲9% YTD but remains the deepest value at 8.9x.

The structural signal: the four largest caps — two telecoms, cement, foods — were all flat WoW, meaning index-level consolidation is a heavyweight freeze masking an aggressive, stock-selective banking rotation concentrated in First HoldCo's recapitalisation trade.

SECTION 6 | NIGERIA — EARNINGS & CORPORATE ACTIONS
Earnings Releases

Company	Period	Revenue (₦bn)	PAT (₦bn)	EPS (₦)	Analyst Comment
Aradel Holdings (ARADEL)	FY2025	699.4	757.3	91.59	Beat — PAT +192% YoY; boosted by ND Western/Renaissance acquisition gains. Final DPS ₦23 (total FY ₦33). AGM (results approval) 30 Jul — kept current.
Dangote Cement (DANGCEM)	FY2025	4306.7	1014.9	59.86	Final dividend raised +50% to ₦45/share (from ₦30); ratified at 2 Jul AGM — record ₦753.8bn payout.
Dangote Cement (DANGCEM)	Q1 2026	1190	321.1	19.14	Beat: PBT +35% YoY to ₦421.1bn (from ₦311.9bn); EPS ₦19.14 vs ₦12.29 PY. PAT not separately disclosed.
Thomas Wyatt Nig. Plc	Q1 2026	0.041	0.003	0.00002	Quarterly results released. Period labelling differs across NGX filings (the ~24 Jun release log tags this as Q2 2026); we report the company's stated period.
Fidson Healthcare (FIDSON)	FY2025	119.06	9.88	4.12	Beat: Revenue +41.42% YoY, PAT +124.68% YoY.
E-Tranzact International (ETRANZACT)	FY2025	30.61	2.47	0.27	Miss on profitability: PAT -27.22% YoY despite Revenue +2.39% YoY.
BUA Foods Plc	FY2025	1770	518.39	28.8	Beat: Revenue +16.15% YoY, PAT +94.88% YoY. Final DPS ₦28.00 (qualification 4 Jun already passed).
Chams Holding Company Plc	FY2025	17.65	0.565	0.10	Revenue +18.95% YoY; profit growth described as modest, exact PAT/EPS not disclosed in source.
Academy Press Plc	FY2026 (YE Mar-26)	4.41	0.253	0.317	Miss: Revenue -3.8% YoY, PAT -65% YoY (thin base: prior year included a large one-off other-income item). Final DPS ₦0.10 (down from ₦0.15). Released 6 Jul 2026.
PZ Cussons Nigeria Plc	FY2026 YTD	260.46	49.1	11.80	Beat: PBT +364.1% YoY to ₦77.32bn; PAT +387.7% YoY. Balance sheet deleveraged (group borrowings - 91.7%). This is an 11-month YTD filing.
Oando Plc	FY2025	3180	204.81	30.00	Mixed: Revenue -22.2% YoY to ₦3.18trn; PBT -64.6% YoY to ₦135.76bn (working capital deficit ₦3.76trn); PAT ₦204.81bn (aided by ₦69.05bn tax credit). Oando does not pay dividends. Released 6 Jul 2026.
Chapel Hill Denham NIDF	H1 2026	n/a (fund)	10.63	n/a (per-unit)	PBT -9.81% YoY to ₦10.63bn. Declared Q2 2026 distribution of ₦4.40/unit, qualification 17 Jul 2026. Continues to outperform its 10-Yr FGN bond benchmark.
University Press Plc	FY2026 (YE Mar-26)	3.89	0.214	0.4953	Miss vs Q4 forecast; PAT -52% YoY. Final DPS ₦0.18 (up from ₦0.15), payment 24 Sep 2026. Released 30 Jun 2026 — just inside the 2-week window; include if still relevant next edition.

Dividend Announcements

Company	Type	DPS (₦)	Qualification	Payment Date
Dangote Cement (DANGCEM)	Final (FY25)	45	17 Jun 2026	2 Jul 2026 — increase to ₦45 (from ₦30) ratified at 2 Jul AGM
Aradel Holdings (ARADEL)	Final (FY25)	23	9 Jul 2026	31 Jul 2026
Cornerstone Insurance Plc	Final FY2025	0.28	2 Jul 2026	20/22 Jul 2026
Ikeja Hotel Plc	FY2024 & FY2025	0.15 + 0.30	Early Jul 2026	24 Jul 2026
Julius Berger Nigeria Plc	Final	4.25	N/A	19 Jun 2026 — paid, >2 weeks ago
UAC of Nigeria (UACN)	Final (FY25)	1	11 Jun 2026	26 Jun 2026
FCMB Group (FCMB)	Final (FY25)	0.35	15 Jun 2026	30 Jun 2026
Airtel Africa (AIRTELAFRI)	Final/Interim	4.26	17 Jun 2026	24 Jul 2026
Eterna (ETERNA)	Final (FY25)	0.5	13 Apr 2026	12 May 2026 — paid, >2 weeks ago
Champion Breweries (CHAMPION)	Final (FY25)	0.07	10 May 2026	21 May 2026 — paid, >2 weeks ago

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Week of: 17 July 2026

Fidson Healthcare (FIDSON)	Final (FY25)	1.5	14 Apr 2026	31 Jul 2026
E-Tranzact International (ETRANZACT)	Final (FY25)	12.5	6 Jul 2026	23 Jul 2026
BUA Foods Plc	Final (FY25)	28	4 Jun 2026	15 Jul 2026
Chams Holding Company Plc	Final (FY25)	0.03	18 Jun 2026	10 Jul 2026
Academy Press Plc	Final (FY26)	0.1	16 Sep 2026	25 Sep 2026
University Press Plc	Final (FY26)	0.18	31 Aug 2026	24 Sep 2026
Chapel Hill Denham NIDF	Q2 2026 Distribution	4.4	17 Jul 2026	20 July 2026

AGMs, Rights Issues & Other Corporate Events

Company / Body	Event Type	Date	Key Details
Family Bank (Kenya — NSE)	Listing by introduction	23 Jun 2026	Cross-border item: lists 1.66bn shares at KSh18.00 on NSE Main Market; ~24.1% premium to KSh14.50 placement price. Starting mkt cap ~KSh29.9bn. Flagged from Section 2.
Dangote Refinery	Private placement	15–19 Jun 2026	>2 weeks old — bids reportedly exceeded \$5bn; one of Nigeria's largest corporate capital raises. Liquidity-raising cited as a driver of NGX selling pressure.
Securities & Exchange Commission (SEC)	Market microstructure rule	Approved 16 Jun 2026	>2 weeks old — new tick-size / minimum-trade-quantity framework approved (Group A ≥₦1,000; B ₦500–999; C <₦500). Effective date still not announced; may still be worth tracking despite age.
Julius Berger Nigeria Plc	AGM	18 Jun 2026	>2 weeks old — dividend payout approved.
Ikeja Hotel Plc	AGM	20 Jul 2026	Dividend proposals.
Cornerstone Insurance Plc	AGM / Scheme Meeting	20 Jun & 26 Jun 2026	Dividend and restructuring.
Aradel Holdings Plc	AGM	30 Jul 2026	FY2025 results approval.
Nigerian Exchange (NGX)	Price-formation rule	Week of 15–19 Jun	>2 weeks old — minimum share quantity rules; impacts Group C names.
Regency Alliance Insurance Plc	Rights Issue	Acceptance: 22 Jun – 3 Jul	1-for-5 rights at ₦0.95/share to raise capital.
Jaiz Bank Plc	AGM	24 Jun 2026	Virtual AGM held.
Thomas Wyatt Nig. Plc	Results release	~24 Jun 2026	Q2 2026 financial statement.
Dangote Cement Plc	AGM (17th)	2 Jul 2026	Shareholders approved a secondary listing on the London Stock Exchange and a 50% dividend increase to ₦45/share (record ₦753.8bn total payout). Held in Lagos.
Nigerian Exchange (NGX)	Index Review	1 Jul 2026	Half-Year 2026 rebalancing: NGX 30 drops Oando & Transcorp, admits NASCON Allied Industries & Unilever Nigeria. Meristem Growth/Value, Afrinvest Dividend Yield and Lotus Islamic indices also reconstituted.
PZ Cussons Nigeria Plc	Board / Management Change	~3 Jul 2026	Appointed Oghenekevwe Ogefere as Company Secretary.
MTN Nigeria Communications Plc	Credit Rating Action	1 Jul 2026	Agusto & Co. upgraded MTN Nigeria to Aaa (stable outlook); GCR affirmed AAA(NG)/A1+(NG). Cited strong cash flow, low leverage, and market leadership.
Academy Press Plc	Results release	6 Jul 2026	FY2026 audited results (YE Mar-26) filed; AGM scheduled 24 Sep 2026.
PZ Cussons Nigeria Plc	Results release	6 Jul 2026	FY2026 YTD (11-month, to 31-May-26) results filed with NGX.
Oando Plc	Results release	6 Jul 2026	FY2025 audited results filed; production +32% YoY to 32,482 boepd; no dividend declared.
Chapel Hill Denham NIDF	Results release / Distribution declaration	6–7 Jul 2026	H1 2026 results + Q2 2026 per-unit distribution of ₦4.40 declared.
University Press Plc	Results release	30 Jun 2026	FY2026 audited results (YE Mar-26) filed; 18 kobo final dividend proposed.

EQUINOX FRONTIER MARKETS WEEKLY

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Week of: 17 July 2026

NGX-listed companies (18+ names)	H1/Q2 2026 Earnings Calendar	Published 8 Jul 2026	Nairametrics compiled the NGX Q2/H1 2026 board-meeting & filing calendar: MTN Nigeria (board 29 Jul, filing 30 Jul), Zenith Bank (30 Jul), Access Holdings (30 Jul), Julius Berger (board 30 Jul, filing 31 Jul), May & Baker (30 Jul), Nigerian Breweries (30 Jul), Unilever Nigeria (23 & 30 Jul), AXA Mansard (30 Jul), SUNU Assurances (21 & 30 Jul), Abbey Bank (22 Jul), Haldane McCall (24 Jul), Lafarge/HBM Nigeria (28 Jul), Mecure Industries (28 Jul), Prestige Assurance (28 & 30 Jul), Consolidated Hallmark (29 Jul). Useful forward calendar for next 2-3 editions.
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SECTION 7 | NIGERIA — MACRO DASHBOARD

Currency & FX

Indicator	Latest Value	As-of Date	WoW Change	WoW %
USD/NGN (NAFEM Official)	1,378.08	2026-07-17	-0.26	-0.02%
GBP/NGN	1,861.00	2026-07-17	13.50	+0.73%
EUR/NGN	1,576.39	2026-07-17	9.04	+0.58%
Gold (USD/oz)	4,010.59	2026-07-17	-101.37	-2.47%

Key Macroeconomic Indicators

Indicator	Latest Value	As-of Date	Prior Period	Change
USD/NGN Parallel Rate (Bureau)	1425	2026-07-17	1425	Flat WoW (spread ≈ ₦47 over NAFEM)
Nigeria CPI Inflation (YoY %)	15.91	Jun-26 (rel. 15 Jul)	15.93	-0.02 pp; food 17.52% ▲
CBN Monetary Policy Rate (MPR %)	26.5	2026-05-20 (305th MPC)	26.5	Held; next MPC 21 Jul 2026
Brent Crude (USD/bbl)	87.94	2026-07-17	76.8	+14.7% WoW (US–Iran escalation)
Nigeria Bonny Light (USD/bbl)	71.63	2026-07-01 (latest CBN print)	73.2	-1.57
FGN 10-Yr Bond Yield (%)	18.34	Jun-26 auction (Jan-2035)	17	+1.34 pp
Nigeria Foreign Reserves (USD bn)	51.86	2026-07-14	51.77	+0.09 WoW; 17-yr high, ~10 mths import cover
Any MPC / NBS Event This Week	NBS June CPI 15.91% YoY	2026-07-15	May CPI: 15.93%	Next: CBN MPC 21–22 Jul 2026

Macro Commentary

- The naira held its ground against a firming dollar backdrop: the official NAFEM rate closed effectively flat at ₦1,378.08/\$ (-0.02% WoW), while the parallel rate steadied at ₦1,425, leaving a ₦47 spread (~3.4%). Cross rates weakened modestly on external moves — GBP/NGN rose 0.73% to ₦1,861.00 and EUR/NGN 0.58% to ₦1,576.39 — reflecting dollar softness abroad rather than naira pressure. Reserves accumulation continues to anchor FX confidence.
- The CBN held the MPR at 26.50% (305th MPC), with the next decision due 21–22 July. June CPI eased marginally to 15.91% YoY from 15.93%, the first decline after three monthly increases, though food inflation accelerated to 17.52% — supporting consensus for a hold. The June 10-yr auction stopped at 18.34% (prior 17.00%), while secondary-market average yields eased ~3bps to 17.79% on equity-to-bond rotation. The DMO's ₦1.2tn July auction across 10-, 15- and 20-yr re-openings will test demand at these levels.
- Brent surged 14.70% WoW to \$87.94/bbl on US–Iran escalation and Strait of Hormuz disruption — a windfall tailwind for Nigeria's fiscal and external accounts. Bonny Light's latest official print of \$71.63 (1 July) predates the surge; spot pricing is tracking materially higher pending an updated benchmark quote. Reserves rose \$0.09bn WoW to \$51.86bn (14 July), a 17-year high covering ~10 months of imports.
- Events to watch next week: DMO ₦1.2tn FGN bond auction (20 Jul, settlement 22 Jul); CBN MPC decision (21–22 Jul); Dangote Cement Q2 results (24 Jul).

SECTION 8 | NIGERIA — MARKET METRICS & VALUATION
Valuation Metrics

Metric	Current (17 Jul 2026)	Prior Week (10 Jul 2026)	Change
Market P/E Ratio (large-cap, cap-weighted)	42.95	41.79	+1.16
Banking Sector avg P/E	18.67	17.88	+0.79
Consumer Goods avg P/E	58.44	58.61	-0.17
Oil & Gas avg P/E	36.78	36.85	-0.08
Market Dividend Yield (avg)	+3.75% (carried forward)	+3.75%	n/a

Methodology notes: “Market P/E” uses the NGX Main Board cap-weighted total (42.95x, from 41.79x last week), which excludes the Premium Board's extreme outliers (MTNN ~81,220.5x, up from ~79,599.1x; Dangote Cement ~1,664.8x, unchanged). Sector averages are simple (equal-weighted) averages of constituents across all boards that carry a reported P/E, excluding any individual constituent with a P/E above 100x as a statistical outlier - consistent with the same treatment applied to the headline Market P/E figure. Banking (7 constituents: ETI, Fidelity, GTCO, Sterling, Unity, UBA, Zenith) excludes Wema Bank (768.0x, from 756.7x) and Jaiz Bank (294.1x, down from 318.3x), both likely distorted by post-recapitalisation EPS dilution. First HoldCo (41.2x, up sharply from 29.7x on the week's +38.66% price surge) and Access (8.9x) sit under NGX's “Other Financial Institutions” subsector and are therefore outside the Banking average by classification. Consumer Goods (8 constituents: NB, Dangote Sugar, Honeywell Flour, Cadbury, Nestle, Enamelware, Vitafoam, McNichols) excludes Champion Breweries (1,256.7x, from 1,320.9x), Guinness Nigeria (168.5x), NASCON (134.9x, from 148.1x), Northern Nigeria Flour Mills (145.0x), P.Z. Industries (162.5x, from 180.7x), and Unilever (312.2x, from 314.7x). Cadbury's decline to 89.0x (from 97.7x) kept it inside the average both weeks. Oil & Gas (5 constituents: Japaul, Oando, Conoil, Eterna, Seplat) excludes TotalEnergies Marketing Nigeria (117.6x); Aradel Holdings remains excluded as it has no reported P/E. Prior Week figures are last week's Current values, rolled forward one period. Market Dividend Yield has no updated source this week and is carried forward unchanged; P/B is not derivable from the supplied NGX files. Corporate action note: Sterling Bank's additional listing of 13.81bn ordinary shares (16 Jul) lifted its market capitalisation to N527.43bn (from N396.09bn) with P/E rising to 26.8x (from 25.5x) - an EPS-dilution effect, not a price move.

Foreign Portfolio Investment (FPI)

Metric	Current (May-26)	Prior (Apr-26)	Trend
FPI Buy Value (₦ bn)	87.60	90.84	↓
FPI Sell Value (₦ bn)	96.01	156.94	↓
FPI Buy/Sell Ratio	0.91	0.58	↑
FPI Net Flow (₦ bn)	-8.41	-66.10	↑ (less negative)
FPI as % of Total Turnover	9.45%	13.74%	↓

Source: NGX Domestic & Foreign Portfolio Investment Report, May 2026 (published ~ two weeks after month-end); May 2026 remains the latest available - the June 2026 report had not been published as of 20 July 2026 (verified via NGX/press search), so this table is unchanged from last week's edition and will be refreshed when the June report lands. FPI values converted from N'Trillion to N'billion. Buy = foreign inflow (purchases); Sell = foreign outflow (sales/liquidation). Net Flow = inflow - outflow (negative = net foreign selling). FPI as % of total turnover uses total foreign transactions / total market transactions for the month. Total foreign transactions fell to N0.18361tn in May (9.45% of the N1.94tn market total) from N0.24778tn in April (13.74%), a 25.90% MoM decline in foreign activity - but the Buy/Sell Ratio improved to 0.91 from 0.58 and Net Flow improved to -N8.41bn from -N66.10bn, indicating foreign investors pulled back on both buying and selling, with selling easing far more than buying. Context: the May decline in foreign participation coincides with the T+1 settlement transition (effective 1 June 2026) and FTSE Russell's reclassification pause - factors likely to keep FPI participation subdued in the June print as well.

Valuation Commentary

- The market's cap-weighted P/E rose to 42.95x (from 41.79x). First HoldCo's own multiple re-rated sharply to 41.2x (from 29.7x) purely on the week's +38.66% price surge against a static trailing EPS — now more than double the 18.67x banking sector average rather than a reasonable proxy for it; H1 results on 30 July will reset the denominator. Core banking remains the value anchor at 18.67x average — Zenith 8.6x, Access 8.9x, GTCO 18.2x — a stark discount to Consumer Goods at 58.44x (Nestlé 75.7x) and Seplat at 53.4x, implying the recapitalisation rally has not yet closed banking's valuation gap. Dangote Cement's 1,664.8x remains excluded as an outlier; the reported FY25 EPS of ₦59.86 against the ₦1,047 close implies a P/E closer to 17x, suggesting the NGX-quoted multiple reflects a different EPS denominator that should be reconciled before publication.
- FPI data remains May-vintage: buys ₦87.60bn against sells ₦96.01bn, net -₦8.41bn at just 9.45% of turnover — foreigners are stepping back rather than fleeing, with the buy/sell ratio improving to 0.91. The T+1 transition and FTSE Russell pause keep international sentiment cautious; this remains a domestically-funded rally.

SECTION 9 | INVESTMENT THEME
Theme — Rotation Into Banks, Out of Cyclical

OBSERVATION	The NGX enters the densest reporting cluster of the half-year with the Banking Index already the market's momentum leader (+9.30% WoW, +13.47% MoM) while the ASI consolidates 0.14% below its 52-week high. Fifteen-plus board meetings are stacked into 21–31 July — MTN (29 Jul), Zenith, Access, First HoldCo, May & Baker and Nigerian Breweries (all 30 Jul) — with Dangote Cement's Q2 due 24 July and Transcorp Power having opened the season with a ₦1.50 interim dividend (payment 23 Jul). Value traded of ₦182.5bn last week confirms institutional participation behind the rotation.
DRIVER	Interim earnings expectations are underpinned by MPR at 26.50% sustaining treasury income and lending yields, completed Tier-1 recapitalisations (First HoldCo's ₦500bn CBN threshold exceeded), and interim dividend positioning across FUGAZ names at undemanding multiples — Zenith 8.6x, Access 8.9x versus the 42.95x market P/E. Money-market yields of 18–20% and the DMO's ₦1.2tn bond auction (20 Jul) compete for the same institutional liquidity, making earnings delivery the deciding variable. FX stability (₦1,378 official, reserves at a 17-year-high \$51.86bn) supports consumer-goods margin narratives into results.
IMPLICATION	Overweight banks into the 30 July reporting cluster, favouring cheap beneficiaries (Zenith, Access, Fidelity at 18.7x sector average) over the fully re-rated First HoldCo at 41.2x, where H1 numbers must validate the +97% YTD move. Selective consumer exposure (NB 46.8x, Cadbury 89x) on margin surprise potential; treat industrials as event-driven around DANGCEM's 24 July print. Corporate actions in Nigeria routinely trigger 3–10% single-week moves — position before, not after, the announcement.
RISK	A hawkish surprise or hold-with-tightening-bias at the 21–22 July MPC, or an oversubscribed bond auction pulling yields toward 19%+, would accelerate equity-to-fixed-income rotation and stall the banking trade. Earnings misses in bellwether FUGAZ names — particularly elevated cost of risk or weak deposit growth — would invalidate the overweight, as would profit-taking mechanics seen in BUA Cement (-19% WoW) spreading to banks that have already rallied without published numbers. Escalation in the Strait of Hormuz lifting energy costs pressures manufacturer margins and could reverse the week's cooler-CPI narrative.

SECTION 10 | OUTLOOK — SECTORAL VIEWS & EVENTS TO WATCH
Sectoral Outlook — Coming Week

Sector	View	Conviction	Rationale
Banking	OW	H	Recapitalisation-driven momentum (+9.30% WoW) meets the 30 Jul earnings cluster with FUGAZ names still cheap at 18.67x sector average — Zenith 8.6x, Access 8.9x — against a 42.95x market multiple.
Consumer Goods	N	M	Selective margin stories (Cadbury 89x, NB 46.8x) offset by heavyweight freezes — BUA Foods flat since June on a ~5% free float — and rich sector average of 58.44x.
Oil & Gas	N	M	Brent +14.70% WoW to \$87.94 has not translated into equity performance (index -0.11%; Seplat flat at 53.4x), signalling upside is contingent on production updates rather than crude beta.
Industrial Goods	UW	M	BUA Cement's -18.99% weekly collapse and the -6.26% index decline mark aggressive institutional exit from stretched low-free-float names; DANGCEM's 24 Jul Q2 print is the only near-term re-entry catalyst.
Insurance	N	L	Marginal firmness (+0.25% WoW) and -4.50% YTD leave it the cheapest catch-up trade, but low liquidity caps conviction ahead of late-July results.
Telco (MTN/Airtel)	N	M	Airtel (+156% YTD, ₦21.8tn cap) and MTN (13x, board 29 Jul) paused after their re-rating; MTN's undemanding multiple offers better risk-reward than chasing Airtel's plateau.

OW = Overweight (expect outperformance) · N = Neutral · UW = Underweight · H/M/L = High/Medium/Low conviction

▲ BULLISH FACTORS

- H1 earnings catalyst density: 15+ board meetings 21–31 July with interim dividend potential across Tier-1 banks trading at single-digit multiples (Zenith 8.6x) versus 18–20% money-market yields.
- Cooler June CPI (15.91% YoY, first decline after three monthly rises) plus a firm naira (₦1,378.08, spread ₦47) and reserves at a 17-year-high \$51.86bn underpin a hold at the 21–22 Jul MPC.
- Domestic institutional liquidity remains deep — ₦182.5bn value traded weekly, ₦32.73bn in single-day block crosses — funding the rally independently of FPI, which is only 9.45% of turnover.

▼ BEARISH RISKS

- Fixed-income competition intensifies: the DMO's ₦1.2tn auction (20 Jul) at ~18.3% stop rates against MPR 26.50% could accelerate equity-to-bond rotation already visible in the Sovereign Bond Index (-0.33% WoW).
- Heavyweight concentration risk: the four largest caps (Airtel, DANGCEM, MTN, BUA Foods — ~₦73tn combined) were all flat WoW; any distribution in these frozen names overwhelms breadth, as BUA Cement's -19% demonstrated.
- Foreign absence persists: FPI net flow -₦8.41bn with the T+1 transition and FTSE Russell reclassification pause unresolved, while the Dangote Refinery IPO pipeline remains a structural liquidity overhang.

Events to Watch — Next Week

Date	Event Type	Details & Why It Matters
20 Jul	DMO ₦1.2tn FGN bond auction (10/15/20-yr re-openings; settlement 22 Jul)	Strong subscription at higher stop rates pressures banks' bond books but signals durable fixed-income appetite competing with equities.
21–22 Jul	CBN MPC decision (MPR 26.50%, consensus hold)	A hold with dovish language extends the banking rally; any tightening bias triggers profit-taking in rate-sensitive financials.
24 Jul	Dangote Cement Q2 2026 results	A beat (street TP ₦1,359.79 vs ₦1,047) could unfreeze the Industrial Goods complex; a miss validates the BUA Cement-led sector exit.
29–31 Jul	FUGAZ + MTN reporting cluster (MTN board 29 Jul; Zenith, Access, First HoldCo, NB 30 Jul)	Interim dividends and cost-of-risk prints decide whether the banking overweight extends into August or unwinds into the results.

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